


Vokabulantis animations

Makers of the platformer breakdown the stop motion that brings their characters to life. <https://digit.in/apr20-25>


Epic acquires Cubic Motion

Epic Games has acquired the company behind the facial animations in God of War and Hellblade. <https://digit.in/apr20-26>

BREATHING LIFE INTO VIDEO GAMES



Video game animation – a concoction of art, technology and the love for video games

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rowing up with computers, most of us would have experienced video games at some point that had us marvelling at the animated visuals. As the years have elapsed, and the technology has only reached new heights. From simple, one-dimensional, box-shaped items and characters to cinematic masterpieces today. The presence of Indians in this burgeoning field is increasing over time as our country becomes home to some excellent VFX and animation courses. According to NASSCOM, the Indian

gaming industry is worth approximately \$890 million and there are over 100 game development organisations in the country already. Additionally, Hollywood game studios have also begun widely outsourcing animation to India which gives them access to young, talented individuals and also, well... cheaper labour. Nevertheless, the video game animation industry can net talented game designers a sizable salary. Since gaming is a growing industry in India, the demand is almost consistently on a rise. So, if you envision a career as a video game animator or a video game designer, here's an overview of what you should know and expect.

WHAT IS VIDEO GAME ANIMATION?

Video game animation primarily focuses on game design and the interactive aspects of animation. Game animators merge art and technology to design interactive animated images

and environments for video games. That's not the only thing they do though. Video game animators also have to mold these characters by giving them a personality and presence, which has to come through with their actions. Therefore, thorough collaborative work with the art directors and designers is essential.

Tony Ravo, a video game animator told Game Industry Career Guide that animation in games doesn't just serve the story, but also the game design. He stated, "You have to place as much personality as you can in those frames (that the game supports)". Game animation differentiates itself from film and television animation since the former poses several technical limitations as well as opportunities within the interactive platform of games.

SOFT SKILLS NEEDED

There are four non-negotiable skills video game animators are required to possess in order to succeed in this cut-throat field. Firstly, you must possess a knack for art, design and creativity. For this, you must be an impeccable observer, studying the movement of the world around you and consequently replicating and enhancing it in your own creative manner. You not only have to recreate movements but also envision how these movements will be controlled by real-life players. This is a key separating factor between game animators and animators in other domains since the others don't have to worry about the usability and feeling of movements that have been animated. Understand the fundamentals of weight, mass, balance and momentum to ensure that the characters stay true to the players' understanding of world